

Gate readiness checklist (EVT, DVT, PVT)

The questions to answer before you pass a gate, with a section for each phase.

For every gate

- ☐ The decision is based on **evidence** (test results, measurements), not opinion.
 - ☐ Every open issue has an **owner, a plan, a date** and an estimate of what it costs if deferred to the next phase.
 - ☐ No critical issue is open.
 - ☐ "We feel behind" and "we are genuinely ready" have been discussed as **separate questions**.
 - ☐ The cost and schedule of **holding the gate** (for example a two-week extension) is written next to the cost of passing it.
 - ☐ The decision, who made it and why is recorded.
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EVT gate · does the design work?

- ☐ Every issue found has been triaged to the team that owns it.
 - ☐ Interface issues (problems between two teams) are identified and have both owners.
 - ☐ A cross-team review has been held to surface the "that is not my problem" issues.
 - ☐ Critical issues are fixed and re-tested on hardware.
 - ☐ High issues have a plan that an owner stands behind.
 - ☐ Requirements are verified or have a dated plan to be verified.
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DVT gate · does it pass?

- ☐ Tooling was released on evidence and the evidence is on file.
 - ☐ Certification and reliability tests are complete, or their remaining slots are booked and the risk is stated.
 - ☐ Action items are closed **on hardware**, not just in the tracker.
 - ☐ The sample run was built with production-intent parts and process.
 - ☐ Any change since certification has been checked for a re-test.
 - ☐ Sourcing is confirmed for volume, with single-source parts listed and mitigated.
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PVT gate · can we build it?

- ☐ The readiness check (line, fixtures, parts, trained operators) was passed before the pilot started.
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- ☐ The pilot run met target yield, with defects and rework recorded.
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- ☐ Stress testing (such as HALT) has shown where the weak points are, and the limits are understood.
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- ☐ Process validation is done for every critical step, not just the ones that were easy to measure.
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- ☐ Open issues are quantified in euros and weeks at production prices.
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- ☐ The factory has signed off its own process, in writing.

Why: the book's worked example is a team that passes the DVT gate with two open issues that are "probably fine", declines a two-week extension, and pays five times as much in PVT, where there is no buffer left. The extension is the economically rational choice.

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